User Guide

Canadian TFSA Multi-Brokerage Tracker

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v1.1

MapleSheet Co.

maplesheetco.etsy.com

Track your TFSA across up to 8 Canadian brokerages in a single Google Sheet. Live prices, ACB, combined contribution room against your real CRA numbers, and a dividend tracker that flags the US withholding tax you're paying on US dividend payers — all automatic.

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1. GETTING STARTED

Open your template link

The **Template_Link.pdf** in your download contains a clickable link to the master spreadsheet. Click it, then click **Make a copy** in the dialog that appears. Google creates a personal copy in your Google Drive. From this point on, you work only in your own copy — the master is untouched.

Rename your copy

In the top-left of the sheet, click the title (currently something like "Copy of Canadian TFSA Multi-Brokerage Tracker v1.1") and rename it to something you'll recognize — for example: **TFSA Multi-Brokerage Tracker 2026 — Your Name**.

Reload the browser tab

This is important. After your first open, **close and reopen the browser tab** (or press Ctrl+R / Cmd+R to reload). Wait 5–10 seconds. A new menu called ■ MapleSheet appears next to the Help menu at the top of the sheet. This menu is the heart of the product — everything you need lives there.

> If the ■ MapleSheet menu does not appear: reload the tab one more time. Google sometimes takes an extra moment to load bound scripts on the very first open.

2. THE ■ MAPLESHEET MENU

The ■ MapleSheet menu contains every command you'll need to run. You never have to touch the Apps Script editor — everything is one click.

■ Build / Rebuild All Tabs

The master command. Run this once on first open to build every tab, formula, and dropdown from scratch.

■ Load Sample Data

Reloads 28 demo transactions across several brokerages so you can see how everything connects before entering your real data.

■ Clear Sample Data

This tracker ships with 28 sample transactions already in the Transaction Log. This command wipes the log — formulas and dropdowns stay intact. **Always run this before entering your real transactions.**

■ Rebuild Dashboard Charts

Use this if the dashboard charts disappear after sharing or copying the sheet.

■ About

Shows the product version and a link back to the shop.

3. YOUR FIRST RUN — RECOMMENDED ORDER

Follow these steps in order. Most of the time is spent gathering two numbers from the CRA, not using the sheet itself.

1	Reload the browser tab. Confirm the ■ MapleSheet menu appears.
2	■ MapleSheet → Load Sample Data (if not already loaded). Look around the dashboards to see how everything connects.
3	■ MapleSheet → Clear Sample Data. This wipes the 28 sample rows from the Transaction Log but keeps all formulas and dropdowns.
4	Open ■ Settings & Goals. Fill in the amber cells: your up to 8 brokerage names, your **TFSA Annual Limit** for the current year, and your **TFSA Accumulated Room** from CRA My Account.
5	Open ■ Transaction Log. Add your real transactions, one row per transaction. The dashboards populate automatically.

Your Room Remaining matters most. It's your TFSA Accumulated Room minus what you've contributed YTD across every brokerage, combined — both source numbers come from CRA My Account under Tax Returns → TFSA. Every dashboard's "room remaining" figure is measured against this.

4. TOUR OF THE 7 TABS

Tab	What it does
■ Start Here	Quick-start steps and a menu overview, including How to Clear Sample Data. Read this first.
■ Main Dashboard	Portfolio value, combined TFSA contribution room & YTD summary, and Top Holdings across every brokerage.
■ Transaction Log	Your single source of truth — one row per transaction. Every other tab reads from it.
■ TFSA Portfolio	Combined holdings, live prices, average cost, cost basis, and gain/loss across every brokerage.
■ Institution Dashboard	Side-by-side comparison across all 8 brokerages, plus a Combined column.
■ Dividend Tracker	Monthly dividend + DRIP income, per-ticker breakdown, annual run-rate, and goal progress.
■ Settings & Goals	The only tab you edit directly (amber cells). Your 8 brokerage names, CRA numbers, and goals.

A ninth tab, TFSA CRA Rules, is a built-in plain-English reference to the rules in Section 9. It doesn't drive any calculations — it's there so you don't have to leave the sheet to check a rule.

5. THE TRANSACTION LOG — COLUMN BY COLUMN

The Transaction Log is the only tab you type into. Every other tab reads from it. Never delete rows — your Adjusted Cost Base (ACB) depends on the full history.

Col	Field	How to fill it in
A	Date	Format: yyyy-mm-dd. Example: 2026-01-05.
B	Year	Auto. Fills from column A. Do not edit.
C	Brokerage ▼	Dropdown. Pulls your 8 brokerage names from Settings.
D	Type ▼	Dropdown: Buy, Sell, Contribution, Dividend, DRIP.
E	Ticker	US stocks: ticker only, no prefix (KO, not NYSE:KO). Canadian tickers need an exchange prefix (TSE:XEQT, CNSX: also supported).
F	Description	Free-text. Optional. E.g. 'iShares All-Equity ETF'.
G	Curr	Dropdown: CAD or USD. This — not the ticker prefix — drives accurate CAD conversion.
H	Shares	Required for Buy / Sell / DRIP. Blank for Contribution / Dividend.
I	Price	Required for Buy / Sell / DRIP.
J	Fees	Brokerage commission. Use 0 for commission-free brokerages.
K	Amt	Cash amount in the transaction's original currency.
L	FX (amber)	Auto-fills the live GOOGLEFINANCE rate; overwrite with your actual trade-day rate if you want historical accuracy.
M	Amt (CAD) ★ (auto)	Auto. Locked. Amt × FX, rounded to 2 decimals. Never edit.

6. UNDERSTANDING THE DASHBOARDS

Main Dashboard

Your executive summary. Four cards show Market Value, Cost Basis, Gain/Loss, and Return % across every brokerage combined. Below that, a TFSA Contribution Room & YTD Summary block shows your Annual Limit, Accumulated Room, Room Remaining, Contributed YTD, Withdrawals YTD, and Dividends YTD. A Top Holdings table lists your 5 largest positions by market value.

Institution Dashboard

Side-by-side comparison — the tracker's signature feature. Each column is one of your up to 8 brokerages, with a Combined column at the end. Rows show Market Value, Cost Basis, Gain/Loss, Contributions YTD, Dividends YTD, and each brokerage's % of total contributions. Useful for deciding whether to consolidate or seeing which brokerage is really carrying your returns.

TFSA Portfolio

Combined holdings across every brokerage, one row per ticker: shares, average cost, cost basis, live market value, and gain/loss. Tickers populate automatically as you add Buy/DRIP/Transfer rows to the Transaction Log — nothing to type here.

7. TICKER FORMATS AND LIVE PRICES

The tracker uses Google Sheets' **GOOGLEFINANCE** function to pull live prices. Enter US tickers alone, with no exchange prefix; Canadian and other exchange-listed tickers need their prefix.

Market	How to enter it	Examples
US stocks (NASDAQ / NYSE)	Ticker only — no prefix	KO · JNJ · AAPL
Canadian stocks (TSX)	TSE: prefix required	TSE:XEQT · TSE:VDY
Canadian venture (CSE)	CNSX: prefix required	CNSX:EXAMPLE

If a price shows #N/A: double-check the ticker's exchange prefix rule above, or try File → Spreadsheet settings → Recalculation → 'On change and every minute'.

8. CURRENCY AND FX RATES

US-dollar transactions are automatically converted to CAD. The amber FX column auto-fills the live USD/CAD rate from GOOGLEFINANCE unless you overwrite it.

When to overwrite it: for historical accuracy — if you bought a US stock months ago, the current live rate is not the rate you actually paid. Enter your actual purchase-day rate so your cost basis reflects reality. Leave the live rate in place otherwise.

9. CONTRIBUTION ROOM — HOW THE TRACKER MEASURES IT

TFSA room is simpler than an RRSP's but works differently in one important way: a withdrawal **does** add room back — just not until **January 1 of the following calendar year**, never the same year you withdrew. The tracker's Room Remaining is your TFSA Accumulated Room (from Settings) minus Contributed YTD across every brokerage combined — it does not assume a same-year withdrawal has already freed up room, because CRA doesn't either.

There is no CRA limit on how many TFSAs you can hold or at how many brokerages — your contribution room is one shared number across all of them, which is exactly what the Institution Dashboard's Combined column adds up for you.

Where to find your numbers: sign in to CRA My Account (canada.ca/my-account) → TFSA. Update your TFSA Accumulated Room every January once CRA has posted the new year's room. See the TFSA CRA Rules tab, or the TFSA Government Rules PDF in your download, for the full breakdown including the over-contribution penalty and the December 31 deadline.

10. DIVIDEND TRACKING

The ■ Dividend Tracker tab analyzes all your dividend and DRIP income: YTD Dividends, YTD DRIP, Est. Full Year at current run-rate, your Annual Goal, a monthly bar chart, and a Top Dividend Payers breakdown by ticker.

Cash dividend

Type = Dividend. Fill Ticker, Currency, and Amt. Leave Shares and Price blank. The tracker converts USD dividends to CAD automatically.

DRIP (Dividend Reinvestment)

Type = DRIP. Fill Ticker, Shares (the fractional shares you received), Price (share price on the DRIP date), and Amt = shares × price. This increases your average cost, which the TFSA Portfolio tab handles automatically.

US dividends and the 15% withholding tax

Unlike an RRSP, a TFSA is **not** covered by the Canada–US tax treaty exemption — the IRS withholds 15% at source on US-listed dividend payments held in a TFSA, and it is not recoverable. This is a real cost, not just a reporting line: it reduces every US dividend you log here before it ever reaches your account. See Section 12 of the TFSA Government Rules PDF, or the built-in TFSA CRA Rules tab, for the full explanation.

Set your annual dividend goal

Your Settings annual dividend goal drives the Dividend Tracker's Annual Goal card and progress tracking. Setting a goal makes the whole tab more useful.

11. ANNUAL ROLLOVER — EVERY JANUARY

The tracker is designed to keep running year after year. You never delete history — you just update a few numbers each January:

- File → Make a copy → Rename: 'TFSA Multi-Brokerage Tracker 2027'
- Settings → update the TFSA Annual Limit to the new year's CRA dollar amount
- Settings → update TFSA Accumulated Room once CRA has posted it (remember: a withdrawal made in 2026 only adds back to this number on January 1, 2027 — not the moment you withdrew)
- Start adding 2027 transactions below your existing rows — that's all. Holdings carry forward automatically: average cost preserved, history intact.

DO NOT delete Transaction Log rows. The TFSA Portfolio tab computes your average cost and gain/loss from the full history of every Buy, DRIP, and Sell. Deleting old rows corrupts your cost basis. Also remember: unlike an RRSP, a TFSA has no grace period into the new year — contribute or withdraw by December 31 for it to count for that calendar year.

12. TROUBLESHOOTING

The ■ MapleSheet menu is missing

Reload the browser tab (Ctrl+R / Cmd+R) and wait 5–10 seconds. If it still does not appear, close the tab entirely, then reopen the file from your Google Drive.

Live prices show #N/A or 0

Check column E of the Transaction Log against the exchange-prefix rules in Section 7. Also try File → Spreadsheet settings → Recalculation → 'On change and every minute'.

Dashboard charts disappeared after sharing or copying

■ MapleSheet → Rebuild Dashboard Charts.

Contribution room shows the wrong number

Check your TFSA Annual Limit and TFSA Accumulated Room in Settings — every room calculation on every dashboard is measured against these two numbers. An old value from a prior year is the most common cause.

TFSA Portfolio tickers are missing

The TFSA Portfolio tab pulls unique tickers from the Transaction Log. Make sure every Buy/DRIP/Sell row has a ticker in column E with the correct prefix rule from Section 7.

I accidentally deleted something important

File → Version history → See version history → restore an earlier version. Google keeps every edit forever.

13. SUPPORT AND UPDATES

Message the shop on Etsy: maplesheetco.etsy.com — reply within 1–2 business days.

If you spot a bug or want to request a feature, include: the tab name, the cell reference, a screenshot if possible, and the product version.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Always verify your CRA numbers against your actual CRA My Account.